

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, July 26, 2023, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:00 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne - Joined meeting at 6:07 p.m.

Ward II Councilor James Contois

Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone

Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau – Absent

At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski

At-Large Councilor William Limoges

At-Large Councilor Spencer Batchelder

At-Large Councilor Matthew Mooshian

Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

NON-PUBLIC

Members Present

Councilor O’Hearne entered at 6:07 p.m.

Councilor Batchelder

Councilor Stone

Mayor Girard

Councilor Koloski

Councilor Limoges

Councilor Contois

Councilor Mooshian

Non-Members Invited to Attend Nonpublic Session

Yoshi Manale, City Manager and Nancy Merrill, Planning and Development Director.

Motion to enter Nonpublic Session made by Councilor Limoges seconded by Councilor Stone.

Specific Statutory Reason cited as foundation for the nonpublic session:

RSA 91-A:3, II(d) *Consideration of the acquisition, sale or lease of real or personal property which, if discussed in public, would likely benefit a part or parties whose interests are adverse to the general community.*

Roll Call Vote to enter nonpublic session: Majority vote required

Councilor O’Hearne – (entered at 6:07 p.m.)
Councilor Batchelder - yes
Councilor Stone - yes
Councilor Koloski - yes
Councilor Limoges - yes
Councilor Contois - yes
Councilor Mooshian -yes
Mayor Girard - yes

Motion: PASSED

Entered nonpublic session at 6:00 p.m.

Motion to leave nonpublic session and return to public session by Councilor Batchelder, seconded by Councilor O’Hearne (**Majority vote by roll call.**)

Councilor O’Hearne – yes
Councilor Batchelder - yes
Councilor Stone - yes
Councilor Koloski - yes
Councilor Limoges - yes
Councilor Contois - yes
Councilor Mooshian -yes
Mayor Girard - yes

Motion: PASSED

Public session reconvened at 6:25 p.m.

Note: Under RSA 91-A:3, III. *Minutes of proceedings in nonpublic sessions shall be kept and the record of all actions shall be promptly made available for public inspection, except as provided in this section. Minutes of such sessions shall record all actions in such a manner that the vote of each member is ascertained and recorded. Minutes and decisions reached in nonpublic session shall be publicly disclosed within 72 hours of the meeting, unless, by recorded vote of 2/3 of the members present, it is determined that divulgence of the information likely*

*would affect adversely the reputation of any person **other than a member of this board**, or render the proposed action of the board ineffective, or pertain to terrorism. In the event of such circumstances, information may be withheld until, in the opinion of a majority of members, the aforesaid circumstances no longer apply.*

Motion made to seal these minutes? If so, motion made by Councilor Limoges, seconded by Councilor Batchelder, because it is determined that divulgence of this information affects adversely the reputation of any person other than a member of the public body itself;

such minutes to remain sealed unless and until the purpose for which the information discussed has been requested to be sealed no longer applies.

Roll Call Vote to seal minutes (2/3 vote required)

Councilor O’Hearne – yes
Councilor Batchelder - yes
Councilor Stone - yes
Councilor Koloski - yes
Councilor Limoges - yes
Councilor Contois - yes
Councilor Mooshian -yes
Mayor Girard - yes

Motion: PASSED

Motion to adjourn at 6:26 p.m. made by Councilor Limoges, and seconded by Councilor Batchelder.

Councilor O’Hearne – yes
Councilor Batchelder - yes
Councilor Stone - yes
Councilor Koloski - yes
Councilor Limoges - yes
Councilor Contois - yes
Councilor Mooshian -yes
Mayor Girard - yes

Motion: PASSED

These minutes recorded by: Councilor Limoges

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept the minutes of the July 12, 2023, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

MAYOR’S NOTES

Mayor Girard noted there will be a boxing event at the CSBCC this Saturday at 5:00 p.m.

Next Tuesday, August 1st National Night Out will be held on Pleasant Street from 4:00 p.m. to 8 p.m.

Fiske Free Library is holding their annual meeting Tuesday August 8th at 6:00 p.m.

CITY MANAGER’S REPORT

City Manager Manale announced the sidewalk removal has started on Maple Avenue.

Hoping to have the temporary ADA compliant ramp purchased in the next few weeks.

Parks and Recreation along with Vital Communities are holding an E-bike program, residents can

sign up to rent an E-bike through the Community Center or the Parks and Recreation website. Several complaints for homeless encampments along the Sugar River have prompted a brush clear out to encourage those in the encampment to utilize our shelters.

Annual Rent Survey shows that a two-bedroom apartment in Sullivan County now goes for \$1,316.00 per month which is a 36% increase since 2018. The average in NH is \$1,7640.00. Grafton County is the highest in the state at an 81% increase averaging \$2,081.00.

Claremont received notice for our Congressional Direct Spending. Unfortunately, Claremont did not get funding for the Sugar River Walk, but will be applying again next year. \$1.2 million for the Police Communication and Archive project was moved forward by the Senate. The \$2.3 million for the CDA Claremont Creative Center Project was also moved forward. City Manager Manale thanked Senator Shaheen and Representative Kuster for advocating funding for these projects.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

None.

OLD BUSINESS

Ordinance 609 Cottage Developments Second Reading – Public Hearing

City Planner, Bearse explained Cottage Developments are another tool for creative new housing in Claremont intending to be owner occupied.

CITY OF CLAREMONT – IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-THREE

ORDINANCE #609

ZONING ORDINANCE AMENDMENTS

COTTAGE DEVELOPMENTS

The City of Claremont Ordains:

Pursuant to RSA 675:2 and RSA 674:16, Chapter 22, Zoning, of the Claremont City Code is hereby amended as follows:

Section 1. Definitions.

Amend Section 22-1, Definitions, to add the new definitions for "Cottage" and "Cottage Development" as follows:

Cottage shall mean a detached owner-occupied one-family dwelling unit with a maximum gross living area of one thousand, five hundred square feet (1,500 sq. ft.) and a maximum footprint of one thousand five hundred square feet (1,500 sq. ft.). Porches are to be included in the calculation of maximum footprint. Spaces with a ceiling height of six feet or less measured to the exterior walls, such as in a second-floor area under the slope of the roof,

shall be excluded when calculating the total floor area of a cottage. Cottages may also be attached horizontally in blocks of no more than three (3) units.

Cottage Development shall mean a development on a single lot having shared open space intended to serve cottages that interact together as a small community.

Section 2. Conditional Use Permits.

Amend Section 22-147 to permit "Cottage Developments" in the Agricultural Residential District (AR) subject to receiving a Conditional Use Permit, to read as follows:

Sec 22-147. Conditional use permits.

The following uses may be permitted in the agricultural residential district by the planning board, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-100 et seq., as well as any other applicable regulations of this chapter or regulations of the state.

1. Duplexes.
2. ADUs, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-513.
3. *Cottage Developments, subject to the regulations contained in section 22.514.*

Amend Section 22-167 to permit "Cottage Developments" in the Rural Residential District (RR), subject to receiving a Conditional Use Permit, to read as follows:

Sec. 22-167. Conditional Use Permits.

The following uses may be permitted in the rural residential district by the planning board subject to the regulations contained in section 22-100 et seq., as well as any other applicable regulations of this chapter or regulations of the state.

1. Duplexes.
2. ADUs, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-513. (12/14/2022)
3. *Cottage Developments, subject to the regulations contained in Section 22-514.*

Amend Section 22-187 to permit "Cottage Developments" in the Rural Residential District II (RR-2) subject to receiving a Conditional Use Permit, to read as follows:

Sec. 22-187. Conditional Use Permits.

The following uses may be permitted in the rural residential district II by the planning board subject to the regulations contained in section 22-100 et seq., as well as any other applicable regulations of this chapter or regulations of the state.

1. Duplexes.
2. ADUs, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-513.
3. *Cottage Developments, subject to the regulations contained in section 22.514.*

Amend Section 22-207 to permit "Cottage Developments" in the Residential District I (R-II) subject to receiving a Conditional Use Permit, to read as follows:

Sec. 22-207. Conditional Use Permits.

The following uses may be permitted in the residential district I by the planning board, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-100 et seq., as well as any other applicable regulations of this chapter or regulations of the state and the following conditions and safeguards.

- (1) Conversion of existing single-family homes to duplexes or multiple-family dwellings provided that:
 - a. It involves the conversion of an existing single-family dwelling, and municipal water and sewer are provided.
 - b. The overall density on each lot does not exceed ten thousand (10,000) square feet per dwelling unit for the first dwelling unit and five thousand (5,000) square feet per additional dwelling unit. (12/14/2022)
 - c. The total number of dwelling units does not exceed a maximum of eight (8).
 - d. That off-street parking is provided in accordance with section 22-526 et seq., and that such parking does not violate the yard requirements contained in section 22-209.
- (2) ADUs, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-513.
- (3) *Cottage developments, subject to the regulations in section 22-514.*

Amend Section 22-227 to permit "Cottage Developments" in the Residential District II (R-II) subject to receiving a Conditional Use Permit, to read as follows:

Sec. 22-227. Conditional Use Permits.

The following uses may be permitted in the residential district II by the planning board, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-100 et seq., as well as any other applicable regulations of this chapter or regulations of the state and the following conditions and safeguards.

- (1) Conversion of existing single-family homes to duplexes or multiple-family dwellings provided that:
 - a. It involves the conversion of an existing single-family dwelling, and municipal water and sewer are provided.
 - b. The overall density on each lot does not exceed ten thousand (10,000) square feet per dwelling unit for the first dwelling unit and five thousand (5,000) square feet per additional dwelling unit.
 - c. The total number of dwelling units does not exceed a maximum of eight (8).
 - d. That off-street parking is provided in accordance with section 22-526 et seq., and that such parking does not violate the yard requirements contained in section 22-209.

- (2) ADUs, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-513.
- (3) *Cottage developments, subject to the regulations in section 22-514.*

Amend Section 22-298 to permit "Cottage Developments" in the Business District II (B-II) subject to receiving a Conditional Use Permit, to read as follows:

Sec. 22-298. Conditional Use Permits.

The following uses may be permitted in the residential district II by the planning board, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-100 et seq., as well as any other applicable regulations of this chapter or regulations of the state and the following conditions and safeguards.

- (1) Conversion of existing single-family homes to duplexes or multiple-family dwellings provided that:
 - a. It involves the conversion of an existing single-family dwelling, and municipal water and sewer are provided.
 - b. The overall density on each lot does not exceed ten thousand (10,000) square feet for the first dwelling unit and another five thousand (5,000) square feet per additional dwelling unit.
 - c. The total number of dwelling units does not exceed a maximum of eight (8).
 - d. That off-street parking is provided in accordance with section 22-526 et seq., and that such parking does not violate the yard requirements contained in section 22-209.
- (2) ADUs, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-513.
- (3) *Cottage developments, subject to the regulations in section 22-514.*

Add a new Section to Division 11, Multiple Use Healthcare District (MHU) to provide for Conditional Use Permits to read as follows:

Sec. 22-378. Conditional Use Permits

The following uses may be permitted in the multiple use healthcare district by the planning board, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-100 et. Seq., as well as any other application regulations of this chapter or regulations of the state and the following conditions and safeguards.

- (1) *Cottage developments, subject to the regulations in section 22-514.*

Section 3. Division 11 Multiple Use Healthcare District (MHU).

Renumber the Division 11 section numbers subsequent to the addition of Sec. 22-378, to read as follows:

Sec. 22-379. Special Exceptions.

Sec. 22-3280. Density.

Sec. 22-381. Parking.

Sec. 22-382. General Regulations.

Secs. 22-383 – 22-385. Reserved.

Section 4. Division 12. City Center Zoning Districts

Amend Sec. 22-287, Table of Uses, to add Cottage Developments into the table as a Residential use to appear as follows:

	City Center Residential I District	City Center Residential II District	Professional Residential District	Mixed Use District	City Center Business II District	Additional Regulations Reference (refer to these sections for additional regulations)
Residential	CR-1	CR-2	PR	MU	CB-2	
Single-family dwelling	P	P	P	CU	P	Sec. 22-387.1
Duplex		CU	CU	CU	CU	Sec. 22-387.1
Multifamily dwelling		P	P	CU	P	Sec. 22-387.1
Conversion of existing single-family to duplex	CU	CU	CU	CU	CU	Sec. 22-387.2
Conversion of existing single-family or duplex to multifamily dwelling	CU	CU	CU	CU	CU	Sec. 22-387.2
Accessory dwelling units	CU	CU	CU	CU	CU	Sec. 22-513
Accessory uses and buildings	P	P	P	P	P	
Manufactured housing on individual lots	P	P				Sec. 22-387.4
Planned residential development		SE				Sec. 22-387.5
<i>Cottage developments</i>	<i>CU</i>	<i>CU</i>	<i>CU</i>	<i>CU</i>	<i>CU</i>	<i>Sec. 22-514</i>

Section 5. Section 22-514. Cottage Developments

Add a new Sec.22-514, Cottage Developments, to Division I of Article V, Supplementary District Regulations, and renumber the remaining sections of the Division as follows:

Sec. 22-514 Cottage Developments

514.1 Purpose. The purpose of this section is to provide opportunities for single family housing that is small, energy-efficient, and affordable; to allow flexibility in site and design standards while promoting projects that ensure compatibility with surrounding land uses and existing neighborhoods; and to promote sustainability and neighborhood interaction through integrated design.

Cottage developments are intended to serve as part of the City's overall housing strategy to encourage affordability, innovation and variety in housing design and site development while ensuring compatibility with existing neighborhoods, and to promote a variety of housing choices to meet the needs of a population diverse in age, income, household composition and individual needs.

514.2 Applicable Use Districts. Cottage developments are allowed by conditional use in all zoning districts except the I1, I2 or I3 districts, in accordance with Sections 22-100 and 22-101 of this chapter and the requirements of this section.

514.3 Number and Arrangement of Units. Cottage developments shall contain a minimum of three (3) and a maximum of sixteen (16) cottages, located in one or more clusters to maximize efficiency of land use and to encourage a sense of community among the residents. Each cluster shall include a minimum of three (3) units.

514.4 Lot Size. All cottage developments shall have a minimum lot area of one-half acre, except in the AR, RR, RR2, R1 and R2 Districts, where a minimum lot area of 40,000 sq. ft. is required.

514.5 Density and Building Coverage.

(a) Permitted density shall be based on 2,500 sq. ft. of lot area per each cottage.

(b) The maximum permitted building coverage shall be 60% per cottage lot. This allows for a 1,500 SF home (maximum allowed footprint for a cottage per the definition of a cottage) with 1,000 SF of open space left per cottage lot. 400 SF of that 1,000 SF must be dedicated to common open space (see 509.5D)

514.6 Design Standards. The following design standards are intended to define design parameters to create a small community of cottages oriented around open space and to achieve compatibility with adjacent uses.

A. Individual Cottage Spaces. For each detached cottage, the site plan approved by the Planning Board shall delineate a building site for each detached cottage of no more than 1,500 sq. ft. (Refer to definition of cottage)

B. Detached Cottages. At least 50% of the cottages in the development shall be detached units.

C. Interior Setbacks. The minimum setback between units within a cottage development shall be 10 feet, measured from the nearest point of the exterior walls.

D. Common Open Space. A minimum of 400 square feet of common open space shall be provided per cottage and per cluster. The common open space area for each cluster

shall be contiguous and shall abut all of the cottages in the cluster. Cottages shall be oriented around and have their main entry from the common open space.

E. Roofs and Porches.

1. The highest point of the roof of the cottage shall not exceed 24 feet.
2. Cottages shall have an unenclosed, covered front primary entry and porch of at least 60 square feet in size. The front porch shall be oriented toward a common open space. The intent of this porch requirement is to create outdoor space in each cottage that is visually and physically connected to the common open space and to other cottages. The footprint of the porch shall be included when calculating the total floor area of a cottage.

F. Parking Location and Screening Requirements. The cottage development shall provide a minimum number of off-street parking spaces equal to one (1) parking space per cottage and a maximum number of off-street parking spaces equal to one and a half (1.5) spaces per cottage. In addition:

1. Parking areas shall be screened from public streets and adjacent residential uses by landscaping or architectural screening.
2. Parking areas shall be prohibited in the minimum required front yard.
3. Parking areas shall be separated from the common open space by landscaping or an architectural screen.

G. Existing Dwellings. An existing detached or attached one-family dwelling that is incorporated into a cottage development and is nonconforming with respect to the standards of this section shall be permitted to remain on a site used for a cottage development and shall be considered a cottage for purposes of this section. However, the extent of the noncompliance may not be increased, except unless the proposed change is determined by the Planning Board to be consistent in character, scale and design with the cottage housing development.

H. Street Facing Facades. All cottages within 50 feet of a public street shall have street facing facades that avoid blank walls in order to avoid the appearance of “turning their backs” to the street. For all such cottages, a minimum of 25 percent of the street facing façade shall be comprised of windows and/or glass doors.

514.7 Cottage developments may be permitted subject to satisfactory solution regarding:

- (a) the ownership, use, and maintenance of common open space land to be held in common;
- (b) water supply; and
- (c) wastewater disposal.

Such solution may be a homeowner association or similar legal mechanism.

514.8 Illustrations of Cottage Development Designs.



Secs. 22-515—22-526. Reserved.

Section 6. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to Chapter 22 of the City Code by action of the City Council, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 7. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 8. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect and be enforced immediately upon passage.

By consensus, Ordinance 609 will be brought back to Council for a first reading with changes to the square footage from 1500, and limiting the developments to areas where City water and sewer is available.

Ordinance 610 New Construction – Duplexes RI & R2 Zones - Second Reading – Public Hearing

City Planner Bearse, explained this ordinance will create the possibility to convert single family homes into duplexes.

CITY OF CLAREMONT – IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY THREE

ORDINANCE #610

ZONING ORDINANCE AMENDMENTS NEW CONSTRUCTION OF DUPLEXES IN THE R-I and R-II DISTRICTS

The City of Claremont Ordains:

Pursuant to RSA 675:2 and RSA 674:16, Chapter 22, Zoning, of the Claremont City Code is hereby amended as follows:

Section 1. Conditional Use Permits.

Amend Section 22-207 to permit "Duplexes" in the Residential District I (R-I) subject to receiving a Conditional Use Permit, to read as follows:

Sec. 22-207. Conditional Use Permits.

The following uses may be permitted in the residential district I by the planning board, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-100 et seq., as well as any other applicable regulations of this chapter or regulations of the state and the following conditions and safeguards.

- (4) Conversion of existing single-family homes to duplexes or multiple-family dwellings provided that:
 - a. It involves the conversion of an existing single-family dwelling, and municipal water and sewer are provided.
 - b. The overall density on each lot does not exceed ten thousand (10,000) square feet per dwelling unit for the first dwelling unit and five thousand (5,000) square feet per additional dwelling unit. (12/14/2022)
 - c. The total number of dwelling units does not exceed a maximum of eight (8).
 - d. That off-street parking is provided in accordance with section 22-526 et seq., and that such parking does not violate the yard requirements contained in section 22-209.
- (5) ADUs, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-513.
- (6) *Cottage developments, subject to the regulations in section 22-514.*
- (7) *Duplexes (new construction) provided that:*
 - a) *The architectural design of the duplex is compatible with that of the structures within the immediate neighborhood; and*
 - b) *Parking for the residents is in the side or rear yard, where possible.*

Amend Section 22-227 to permit "Duplexes" in the Residential District II (R-II) subject to receiving a Conditional Use Permit, to read as follows:

Sec. 22-227. Conditional Use Permits.

The following uses may be permitted in the residential district II by the planning board, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-100 et seq., as well as any other applicable regulations of this chapter or regulations of the state and the following conditions and safeguards.

- (4) Conversion of existing single-family homes to duplexes or multiple-family dwellings provided that:
 - a. It involves the conversion of an existing single-family dwelling, and municipal water and sewer are provided.

- b. The overall density on each lot does not exceed ten thousand (10,000) square feet per dwelling unit for the first dwelling unit and five thousand (5,000) square feet per additional dwelling unit.
 - c. The total number of dwelling units does not exceed a maximum of eight (8).
 - d. That off-street parking is provided in accordance with section 22-526 et seq., and that such parking does not violate the yard requirements contained in section 22-209.
- (5) ADUs, subject to the regulations contained in section 22-513.
 - (6) *Cottage developments, subject to the regulations in section 22-514.*
 - (7) *Duplexes (new construction) provided that:*
 - a) *The architectural design of the duplex is compatible with that of the structures within the immediate neighborhood; and*
 - b) *Parking for the residents is in the side or rear yard, where possible.*

Section 2. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to Chapter 22 of the City Code by action of the City Council, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 3. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 4. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect and be enforced immediately upon passage.

By Consensus Ordinance 610 will be brought back for a first reading at a future City Council Meeting.

NEW BUSINESS

City Auction Discussion

City Clerk, Melcher explained the following motion was for the Council to approve the sale of five properties to auction.

Motion to Sell Property Acquired by Tax Deed

The Claremont City Council, pursuant to RSA 80:80, hereby authorizes the City Manager, or his designees, to transfer title to real estate acquired by the City by tax collectors deed for nonpayment of taxes by public auction at the following addresses:

263 North Street

60 Central Street

30 Hanover Street

North Street, Map 120, Lot 340

Tremont Street, Map 120, Lot 199

The City Council authorizes the City Manager or his designees to undertake all such actions as may be required to implement this motion.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Stone to sell property acquired by tax deed.

Roll call:

O'Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2024-8 Energy Efficiency and Conservation Block Grant – Public Hearing

Director Merrill explained the city grant writers had brought this to the City's attention and was reviewed by the Department of Energy essentially for a study of where solar would and would not work and then to give a recommendation.

Resolution 2024-8

Application for Grant Funds from Department of Energy/Energy Efficiency and Conservation Block Grant (EECBG)

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont, New Hampshire (the “City”) has identified resiliency, sustainability, and efficiency as priorities for the City’s energy policies through its Master Plan; and

WHEREAS the EECBG has noticed federal funding availability to include services for municipal solar planning;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED to apply for a grant from the U.S. Department of Energy in an amount up to \$450,000, and if awarded, to accept and expend said funds for these purposes; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED to authorize the City Manager or his designees to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution.

Dated this 26th day of July, 2023 the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Batchelder and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to accept Resolution 2024-8. Amended to add no impact on the tax rate.

Councilor Batchelder read Resolution 2024-8 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2024-9 Congestion Mitigation grant (CMAQ) on Washington Street – Public Hearing

Director Merrill explained Resolution 2024-9.

RESOLUTION 2024-9

**Supplemental Appropriation for Infrastructure
Improvements - Washington Street Signals
Optimization Project
Congestion Mitigation & Air Quality Program (CMAQ)**

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont, New Hampshire (the "City") received NH Department of Transportation funds in 2018 to link ten traffic signals on a two mile stretch of Washington Street anticipated to cost \$652,600 (the "Grant"); and

WHEREAS acceptance of this Grant required that the City provide local matching funds in the amount of 20%, or \$130,520, for the project which the City Council authorized in the 2019 budget; and

WHEREAS engineering services and construction bids have increased project expenditures to \$872,144.53 requiring the City to provide additional local matching funds in the amount of \$43,909.00.

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED to raise and appropriate the sum of \$43,909.00 as the City's match for the Project, said sum shall be in addition to the funds already appropriated, spent and/or encumbered previously, with offsetting revenue to come from the Municipal Transportation Capital Reserve Fund (to have no impact on the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED to authorize the City Manager or the Treasurer, or their designees, to withdraw said funds from the Municipal Transportation Capital Reserve Fund; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the city manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. *(2B Vote Required)*

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Koloski to accept Resolution 2024-9.

Councilor O’Hearne read Resolution 2024-9 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2024-10 ARPA Grant – Public Hearing

Chief Chamberlain explained to the Council Resolution 2024-10 and is seeking approval for the ARPA Grant, which is last of the FAA COVID grants to be awarded.

RESOLUTION 2024-10

SBG 02-22-2023 ARPA (American Rescue Plan Act) O&M Grant

WHEREAS by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont has been awarded a grant from ARPA (American Rescue Plan Act) O&M Grant in the amount of \$32,000.00 to reimburse the City’s Municipal Airport for operational expenses; and

WHEREAS the City would like to accept and transfer grant funds to the Airport Special Reserve Fund.

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the City Council hereby accepts the ARPA (American Rescue Plan Act) O&M grant (SBG 02-22-2024) in the amount of \$32,000.00, with no impact on the tax rate; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. *(2/3 vote required)*

Dated this 26th day of July, 2023, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne to accept Resolution 2024-10.

Councilor Stone read Resolution 2024-10 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O'Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

CSBCC Final Report

Director Lawrence presented the action plan for the CSBCC via power point.



Resources Used to Formulate Action Plan



- ▶ Active Entities Consulting, LLC report
- ▶ Spring 2023 CSBCC Member Survey
- ▶ Outside Facility Visits
- ▶ ActiveNet Software
- ▶ Staff Input

Introduction to Action Plan

- ▶ Define Director objectives for the short-term and long-term at CSBCC
- ▶ Establish SMART goals that will drive results toward the objectives (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-Based)
- ▶ Outline viable actions to help achieve the SMART goals
- ▶ Provide details on how actions will be implemented to achieve goals



Director Objectives for CSBCC



- ▶ Increase overall cost recovery and reduce tax subsidy as it relates to operations of CSBCC
- ▶ Create the best possible value for members and visitors of the community center
- ▶ Build an increased sense of community through CSBCC

SMART Goals for Cost Recovery

Goal	Timeline
Goal 1: Achieve 55% cost recovery for CSBCC budget in FY 2023-24	Review at end of FY 2023-24. Revisit and set new goal annually.
Goal 2: Increase membership units at CSBCC from 1,330 to 1,450	Review at end of FY 2023-24. Revisit and set new goal annually.
Goal 3: Increase total room rentals at CSBCC 25% from FY 2022-23 to FY 2023-24.	Review at end of FY 2023-24. Revisit and set new goal annually.
Goal 4: Obtain services of an optimal recreation software system.	Review at end of FY 2023-24. Current ActiveNet contract expires in December 2023.
Goal 5: Assess all recreation programs supported by the CSBCC budget and ensure they are self-sustaining.	Review at end of FY 2023-24.

Goal 1: Achieve 55% cost recovery for CSBCC budget in FY 2023-24

- ▶ Action 1: Routinely review fee schedule for CSBCC.
- ▶ Action 2: Develop and launch new marketing efforts.
- ▶ Action 3: Eliminate "free" space rentals.
- ▶ Action 4: Sell additional sponsorship banners/advertising space at CSBCC.
- ▶ Action 5: Create a plan to collect past due balances.



Goal 2: Increase membership units at CSBCC from 1,330 to 1,450.



- ▶ Action 1: Marketing. See Objective 1, Action 2.
- ▶ Action 2: Create a former member survey to obtain feedback.
- ▶ Action 3: Participate in nearby fairs and networking events to bolster awareness of CSBCC and offerings.
- ▶ Action 4: Visit facilities like CSBCC and gather information on how they attract new members.
- ▶ Action 5: Look at opportunities to implement corporate memberships.
- ▶ Action 6: Research silver sneakers program at CSBCC.

Goal 3: Increase total room rentals at CSBCC 25% from FY 2022-23 to FY 2023-24.

- ▶ Action 1: Marketing. See Objective 1, Action 2.
- ▶ Action 2: Redirect those looking to host birthday parties and other celebrations at Arrowhead to CSBCC.
- ▶ Action 3: Address the internet access at CSBCC.



Goal 4: Obtain services of an optimal recreation software system.



- ▶ Action 1: Schedule demos with various software companies.
- ▶ Action 2: Research like organizations that are responsible for facilitating programming in addition to managing a membership driven facility.
- ▶ Action 3: Compare and contrast all the companies that demos are conducted with.

Goal 5: Assess all recreation programs supported by the CSBCC budget and ensure they are self-sustaining.

- ▶ Action 1: Furnish program plans for all recreation programs supported by the CSBCC budget.
- ▶ Action 2: Increase fees, adjust program content, or pursue the appropriate sponsorship for all programs that do not breakeven.



SMART Goals for Creating Value

Find Creative Ways to Give Users More

Goal	Timeline
Goal 1: Introduce ten new self-sustaining program offerings at CSBCC.	Timeline: Review by end of FY 2023-24. Revisit and set new goal annually.
Goal 2: Reconfigure fitness room with new and additional equipment.	Timeline: In progress. Will be finished in the Fall of 2023.
Goal 3: Announce expanded fitness class schedule.	Timeline: Review by end of FY 2023-24.
Goal 4: Return to 100% of open pool hours.	Timeline: Due January 2024.
Goal 5: Revamp the member appreciation program at CSBCC.	Timeline: Launch in January 2024.
Goal 6: Introduce a reconstructed personal training program and capitalize on an add-on service could generate \$50,000 - 60,000 in additional revenue annually.	Timeline: Begin in FY 2024-25 (pending creation of new personal trainer positions)

Goal 1: Introduce ten new self-sustaining program offerings at CSBCC.



- ▶ Action 1: Emphasize expansion of pool program offerings.
- ▶ Action 2: Create structured program offerings for our large after school population.
- ▶ Action 3: Research possible community center additions such as a climbing wall, Ninja Cross Systems, diving board, etc.
- ▶ Action 4: Explore non-traditional programming options to get hit different niches that we do not serve already.

Goal 2: Reconfigure fitness room with new and additional equipment.

- ▶ Action 1: Take delivery of new fitness equipment (replacements and new additions).
- ▶ Action 2: Rework the space in the fitness center coming out of COVID.
- ▶ Action 3: Apply fresh paint and a new look to compliment new equipment.



Goal 3: Announce expanded fitness class schedule.



- ▶ Action 1: Evaluate current staff capacity to offer weekend and night classes.
- ▶ Action 2: Brainstorm a list of new class types that we can explore offering at CSBCC.
- ▶ Action 3: Recruit new fitness instructors who can help CSBCC offer classes at night and on weekends.
- ▶ Action 4: Introduce subcontractor facilitated classes

Goal 4: Return to 100% of open pool hours.

- ▶ Action 1: Continue offering in-house lifeguard training programs and incentives for continued employment
- ▶ Action 2: Implement an employee referral program.



Goal 5: Revamp the member appreciation program at CSBCC.



- ▶ Action 1: Pursue sponsors for each monthly member appreciation celebration
- ▶ Action 2: Implement new monthly giveaways or contests.

Goal 6: Introduce a reconstructed personal training program and capitalize on an add-on service could generate \$50,000-60,000 in additional revenue annually.

- ▶ Action 1: Hire personal trainers as employees of CSBCC, rather than contractors.
- ▶ Action 2: Roll out new personal training program options



SMART Goals for Building an Increased Sense of Community

Goal	Timeline
Goal 1: Host quarterly major special events at CSBCC.	Begin this special event pattern in January 2024.
Goal 2: Establish three new partnerships and work with local organizations to aid in community support efforts.	Complete by July 2024. In progress.
Goal 3: Implement a CSBCC Volunteer & Internship Program.	Launch by July 2024.
Goal 4: Introduce a program initiative for young families and kids' activities and identify three new programs that serve them.	Launch programs by January 2024.
Goal 5: Reduce facility user complaints by 50% based on member survey statistics.	Complete by July 2024. Revisit and set new goal annually.

Goal 1: Host quarterly major special events at CSBCC

- ▶ Action 1: Continue partnership with local Rotary Club to host event lineup for "Claremont's First Night."
- ▶ Action 2: Successfully execute "Boxing Back in Claremont".
- ▶ Action 3: Identify at least two other major special event opportunities that utilize the facility to generate revenue



Goal 2: Establish three new partnerships and work with local organizations to aid in community support efforts.



- ▶ Action 1: Evaluate active partnerships and assess how the community center is used to help with community support efforts.
- ▶ Action 2: Identify local organizations and reach out possibly creating new partnerships to serve the community.

Goal 3: Implement a CSBCC Volunteer & Internship Program.

- ▶ Action 1: Work with local school organizations to gauge interest and promote the opportunity to volunteer in certain capacities at the community center.
- ▶ Action 2: Work with local colleges to build and promote the opportunity for valuable internship experience at CSBCC.



Goal 4: Introduce a program initiative for young families and kids' activities and identify three new programs that serve them.



- ▶ Action 1: Survey young families in town.
- ▶ Action 2: Pursue partnerships with potential third-party organizations that may have a vested interest in facilitating children's programs at CSBCC.

Goal 5: Reduce facility user complaints by 50% based on member survey statistics.

- ▶ Action 1: Mitigate increased disruption at the community center after school.
- ▶ Action 2: Investigate ways to address the parking problem.
- ▶ Action 3: Improve pool hours.
- ▶ Action 4: Make maintenance of equipment and building fixtures a top priority.



Action Plan Conclusion

- ▶ CSBCC and its benefits are viewed in a favorable light by members.
- ▶ The action plan must remain a "living" document.
- ▶ The action plan should be adjusted periodically.
- ▶ Objectives are achievable by building toward SMART goals by activating the actions which correspond to them.

Councilor Koloski shared many concerns, and noted a boring pool.

Director Mulholland stated the Human Resource Director, Jamie Young, contacted Primex. Primex stated the diving board was allowed but they obstacle course was not.

Councilor Koloski asked if the City can self-insure for risk at the pool, Director Mulholland will follow up.

Mayor Girard shared concern for parking and asked if there was a need for more than fifty spots on a regular basis. Director Lawrence noted if the memberships grow there will be a need for additional parking.

Councilor Koloski wants to better advertise for the City lifeguard reimbursement.

Councilor Stone shared concern for COVID spacing, and asked why it was still set up this way. Director Lawrence stated it is because there is new equipment coming and figured it could wait and only have to move all the equipment once.

Councilor Koloski suggested a suggestion box, Councilor O’Hearne asked if there was a way to make it electronic.

Manager Manale stated the CSBCC can work with Nancy Meyer to develop this.

Councilor Mooshian suggested updating the website and noted it was too text heavy.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Stone reported the Policy Committee reviewed the final version of the Tree Policy, and has a tentative meeting for August 22nd.

Councilor Contois reported the Conservation Commission has an ecological-assessment at Cathole and working on the National Resource Inventory, just completed the yearly monitoring of Stevens Brook Easement, and LUCT Resolution language has been completed, and waiting for it to be placed back on the Council Agenda.

Councilor Batchelder noted the Historic District Committee did not meet in June, and the next meeting is July 27th.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Limoges asked for the authorization of Director Lawrence to look into trainer fees and corporate fees.

Councilor Kolski would like information on cruiser Opticom’s.

Councilor O’Hearne had a concern for street lights on Washington, Heritage, and Pearl. City Manager, Manale will follow up with DPW.

Councilor O’Hearne asked for an update on the damage at the parking garage.

Manager Manale noted the first damaged glass is being paid by the person who did the damage, but is unsure where investigation is at for the second glass that was damaged, and noted the cost is about \$3,000.00 for each glass and installment.

Councilor Limoges noted Old Newport Road has a sink hole forming, and DPW did place traffic cones but it looks like someone stole the cones and suggested to put up a barricade.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 8:46 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to adjourn.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro

Clerk to the Council